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Industry & Competitive Analysis

For the Local Food and Food
Distribution Industry



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1. Opportunity Overview

1.1. Opportunity Description

Our opportunity, Eden, can best be easily described as the AirBNB for farmer's markets.

The Eden digital platform provides sellers of local products access to a much wider market of buyers and provides buyers much greater convenient access to sellers. By providing a seamless desktop and mobile market, social media, educational components, Eden satisfies the consumer demand for supply chain transparency, authenticity provided by local products, interpersonal interactions, sustainable food, and shopping convenience in one application. Importantly for the sellers, Eden offers a sales analytics platform that provides users with valuable insight into their sales that can help them optimize their business. It is also a marketing pain reliever as many of the marketing tasks each seller has had to do on their own can now be provided for with Eden, thus reducing the seller's overall workload.

Eden's revenue streams come from a variety of sources. The base functionality of Eden is free. Eden allows for either an individual transaction fee or a subscription fee based on sales volume that can be chosen by the seller for transacting on the platform. Ads will be placed in weekly newsletters and on the website but not mobile application. Eden allows for sellers to pay to have their products promoted, and lastly, Eden will allow for sellers to purchase more advanced analytics capability on the platform as they are developed.

The Eden team consists of three members: Garrison Bullock, Stephanie Frank, and Shkar Mohammed. Each member has their own unique strengths that are well complemented by the other team members.

1.2. 30-Second Elevator Pitch

Our team at Eden understands the importance of microeconomics and local entrepreneurship. Access to local and fresh produce markets is inconsistent, inconvenient, and informationally deficient about when and where these products are offered. Valued at \$40 billion, our total available double-sided market for grocery e-commerce in the U.S. alone is growing at 10.2% annually from Covid-19 tailwinds. The EDEN marketplace is a peer-to-peer virtual supply chain that empowers people to grow, buy, and sell fresh produce within their communities through our convenient and seamless transaction process. We at Eden invite you to think locally and thrive globally.

1.3. NAICS and SIC Codes

	<i>Description</i>	<i>NAICS</i>	<i>SIC</i>
Food Industry	Fruit and Vegetable Markets	445230	5431
	Meat Markets	445210	5421
	Fish and Seafood Markets	445220	5421
Tech Platform	Data Processing, Hosting, and Related Services	518210	7374
	Business to Consumer retail sales Internet sites	454110	5961
	Internet Publishing and Broadcasting and Web Search Portals	519130	8999

1.4. Industry and Industry Segments Discussion

Our Eden concept does not strictly fall within a single NAICS or SIC code as Eden is both in the food industry yet is still a digital content platform. The Fruits and Vegetable Markets category “comprises establishments primarily engaged in retailing fresh fruits and vegetables” with the 445 NAICS subsector designating nonstore retailers.⁸

Our industry analysis focus is based on the Fruit and Vegetable Market category. Even though the Eden platform itself is a technology product, the primary industry Eden will serve is the food industry with secondary industries being non-food products or local services typically found at a farmer’s market, such as candles, soaps, or blade sharpening services.

2. Dominant Economic Features of the Industry Environment

Analyzing dominant economic features of an industry provides insight on how certain economic measurements reflect and influence industry activity. The industry environment is a set of factors which directly influence a firm’s competitive actions and responses. These factors can be analyzed using Porter's Five forces model, which will be discussed in section five.⁷ The economic indicators serve as proverbial “canaries in the coal mine” of the industry.

2.1. High Degree of Fragmentation

Small specialty food companies can compete effectively by offering locally sourced and specialty products, providing superior service, or serving a local market. The US industry is highly fragmented: the 50 largest companies account for less than 20% of sales. Distributors and farm

cooperatives are important because the supply and retail segments for many categories in the specialty food industry are highly fragmented, and not all grocers have invested in e-commerce.

2.2. Inelasticity and Substitution

Non-durable commodities, such as food, have an inelastic demand. Regardless of the economic situation, individuals must purchase food. The types of food products that will be substituted depend on disposable income and consumer confidence. Lower priced food items will be substituted for food items that command a price premium.

2.3. Effects of Covid-19

Covid-19 has resulted in an unprecedented increase in demand at food-at-home outlets. The surge in grocery ecommerce amid the Covid-19 pandemic should continue to aid digital sales growth as many customers will likely stick to the e-commerce channel. Food-at-home demand will likely stay permanently elevated versus pre-pandemic levels because of newly formed habits and long-term work from-home adoption.

2.4. Grocery e-commerce

Physical grocery retail stores (supermarkets and hypermarkets) are still the dominant sales channels for Food, as eCommerce in this category is still comparatively underdeveloped. Food remains the last frontier of online retailing. The online share of the Food market is expected to grow by 8% annually from 2019 to 2023.⁴ Prior to the pandemic, online grocery sales were projected to grow to 4.3% of total U.S. grocery sales in 2020. Online grocery sales are now expected to be 10.2% of total U.S. grocery sales in 2020, and by 2025, online grocery sales could reach over 21% of total U.S. grocery sales.¹⁰

Relevant Economic Indicators

Consumer Price Index - Food-at-Home

The Consumer Price Index (CPI) is a measure of the average change over time in the prices paid by urban consumers for a market basket of consumer goods and services as well as a measure of economy-wide inflation. The food-at-home index measures grocery store or supermarket food purchases. Increasing CPI-food-at-home indicates that prices for food have increased and consumers, therefore, will have less purchasing power for their food items. It can also indicate increased demand for food-at-home. In 2020, food-at-home prices increased 3.5% and food-away-from-home prices increased 3.4%.⁹

Gasoline Price Index

Higher gas prices mean that discretionary spending goes down and shoppers will drive less to conduct their purchases. Retailers are further squeezed as they are forced to pass on the expenses associated with increased shipping costs to consumers. Anything that must be shipped or transported could cost more as gas prices rise. Energy Information Administration (EIA) projects regular gasoline retail prices will average \$2.15 per gallon in 2020 and \$2.22 in 2021.¹⁰

Consumer Confidence Index

When consumer confidence is high or rising, it is often accompanied by increased spending and borrowing. Conversely, when consumers are uncertain about the future, they may reduce or postpone expenditures. Consumer confidence remains well below pre-pandemic levels as

consumers remain concerned about their financial prospects, which could lead to a sense of diminished purchasing power and curtail spending for food items considered to be unnecessary.

3. Driving Forces

3.1. Price of Food

There is a natural cap on revenues of food and staples retailing companies, but that also means sales are not significantly affected during economic downturns as demand for food at-home foods being less elastic than the demand for out-of-home foods.¹ Elasticity tends to increase with superior food products not viewed as commodities.

3.2. Disposable Income & Retail Gasoline Prices

As personal income increases, consumers are generally willing to be looser with their expenditures. Conversely, as disposable income remains stagnant or decreases, consumers are less willing to spend. Consumers will substitute for lower cost alternatives. Higher gas prices mean that discretionary spending (i.e., disposable income) goes down and consumers will drive less to purchase items. Any shipping costs could increase as gas prices increase. Real disposable personal income growth has fallen since the fourth quarter of 2018, and this trend will likely continue against the backdrop of economic uncertainties.

3.3. Sustainability

There is increasing awareness of the environmental impact of food choices. Among product features consumers care about, items related to health and sustainability rank high. Consumer preferences are shifting towards preference of sustainable food options, to include organic and local, that have a lower negative environmental impact. Consumers are increasingly prepared to pay a premium, as worldwide sales have grown on average 9.3% every year between 2005 and 2018.⁴ It is clear that conscientious consumption, where consumers pay close attention to the ethics of their purchases, is growing in importance. Transport also continues to be a key consideration as it involves every stage of the supply chain. The global issue of its huge carbon footprint is further complicated by the increasing need for refrigeration and an extended cold chain, often in markets with a limited electrical infrastructure.¹¹

3.4. Supply Chain Transparency and Traceability

There is a general erosion of trust in big institutions like governments and corporations. Companies are under pressure from governments, consumers, NGOs, and other stakeholders to divulge more information about their supply chains, and the reputational cost of failing to meet these demands can be high. Consumers are increasingly demanding to know supply-chain related information about ingredients, food fraud, animal welfare, child labor, chemical usage, and country of origin. Consumers may be willing to pay 2% - 10% for products from companies that provide greater supply chain transparency.²

Since the pandemic, consumers are spending more money on their meals at home and are more conscious about the origin of the ingredients, how healthy the food is, and its ecological footprint. The pandemic has also highlighted the fragility of global supply chains. Blockchain technology can be leveraged as a vehicle for trust and transparency. Food safety issues cost the industry around US\$77 billion per year, and blockchain is an invaluable tool for manufacturers.¹¹

3.5. Convenience

The trade-off between quality, price, and convenience has been permanently broken down. Consumers want it all, with no compromise. With customer experience widely recognized as the number one driver of brand differentiation and success, convenience has never had a broader application or higher profile. Demand for ethical and humane production is matched by the demand for low prices, sustainable processes, living wages, healthy foods, good corporate citizenship and more.¹¹

Other Global Mega-Trends

Authenticity and Experience

Consumers are sharing their food on Instagram and Pinterest, pursuing authentic dining in and out of the home, and reading foodie blogs to discover the latest trends and dining experiences. Put simply, consumers will buy products that feel true to the story they tell about themselves. The search for authenticity is primarily a reaction to mass production. It reflects the joy of discovery and importance of narrative for today's consumers. Authenticity is also closely linked to consumers' growing interest in localism, supporting businesses, and products sourced close to home. It also relates to the continued rise of artisanal brands and the Experience Economy, where consumers (especially cash-poor Millennials) actively choose to spend their money on doing something rather than physically owning something.

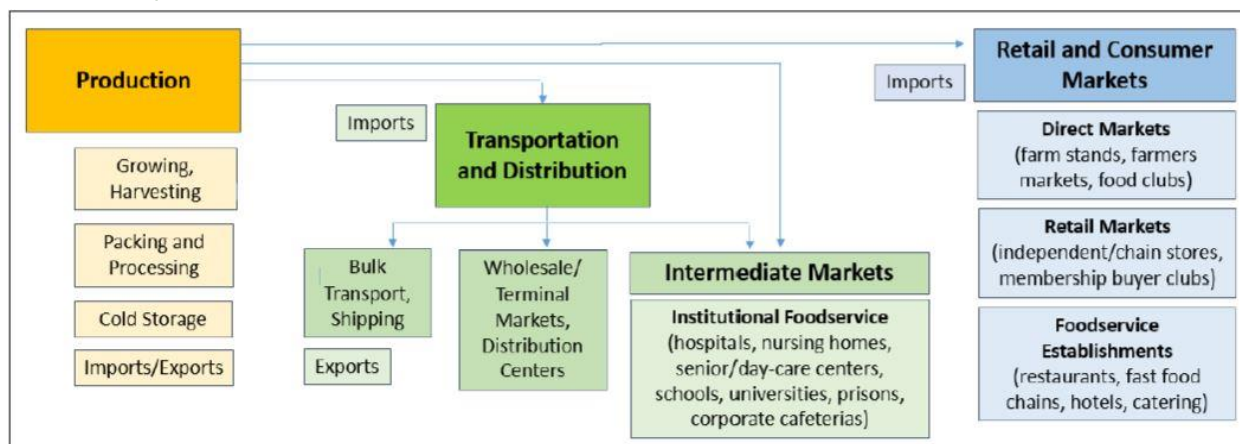
Meat alternatives

The shift toward plant-based meat alternative food products stems from an increase in specific diets, such as flexitarian or vegan, and the desire to support environmentally sustainable alternative food products. In 2018, Euromonitor reported that the alternative meat market grew 11 times faster than the actual meat market.¹¹

Local

The increasing worldwide demand for ethnic and locally grown foods has continued to grow. In part, the increase comes from immigrant consumers seeking out foods from their own cultures.⁶ The local movement reflects consumers shifting preferences for authenticity, consumer experience, and increasing sustainability in the food choices.

4. Industry Value Chain



Source: COVID-19: Supply Chain Disruptions in the U.S. Fruit and Vegetable Industry: In Brief May 8, 2020

The value chain that connects the different parts of the fruit and vegetable industry starts with the production processes by producers that include growing and harvesting, packing, and processing, storing, and then importing and exporting. Products are typically imported through either direct transportation and distribution (through which products can also be transported in bulk and shipped to be exported or supply institutional food services through intermediate markets), or through retail and consumer markets.

The fruit and vegetables supply chain is in continual flux as it is shaped and reshaped by the emergence of new markets and changes in consumer demand. Actors along the supply chain – from growers to retailers – are expanding and consolidating. Their advances coincide with a notable drive towards greater efficiency, a trend that is assisted by seemingly unstoppable technological advance.

As with other supply chains, the one for fresh fruit and vegetables has long been commoditized. This supply chain has been characterized by an overwhelming focus on cost reduction. Until recently, it has been considered to be of limited strategic value. The situation is already changing, and these characteristics are likely to become less dominant over time as consumers' requirements evolve and the supply chain responds to these changing demands. This evolution will be led both by increased demand for higher-quality produce and by a broadening of the produce range. This presents a strategic opportunity for everyone in the fresh fruit and vegetable supply chain – growers, suppliers, and retailers. Already, a number of actors have started to recognize the emerging value and have taken the first steps to gain control over their fresh produce supply. While cost and efficiency will continue to play a significant role in driving the fruit and vegetable supply chain in the coming years, the chain will also be characterized more and more by four key developments that meet emerging requirements:

4.1. More Rapid Supply

In increasing the speed of the supply chain, the objective is to enhance the freshness of the produce in order to deliver quality in line with growing consumer expectations.

4.2. More Flexible Supply

Increasing the flexibility of the supply chain is aimed at ensuring continuity and fulfilment in supply. There are many reasons why the fresh produce chain can be interrupted – for example, the impact of unexpected weather patterns or pest infestations – while customers' demands are also evolving, as already discussed. To stay in touch with demand therefore requires agility, particularly if cost targets are to be met

4.3. More Precise Supply

Another objective is to attain increased accuracy and reliability in supply chain processes. This will become even more important as the fresh fruit and vegetable supply chain develops in ways that makes it increasingly heterogeneous and thus subject to increased volatility. A key approach to achieving superior precision in supply chain operations is through the use of better demand and supply forecasting, as well as increased automation.

4.4. More Transparent Supply

The most critical challenge for the fresh fruit and vegetable supply chain is its inherent lack of transparency. Despite years of effort and often significant investment, there is still insufficient data availability. Even the data that is available is often of inadequate quality. Combined with a lack of interoperability and with only limited information on product lifecycles and transportation history, this results in a high level of manual intervention and paperwork.

5. Competition Analysis (Porter's Five Forces Model of Competition)¹⁰

The closest industry we could identify for the five forces analysis is the food distribution industry.

5.1. Threat of New Entrants or New Entry (High)

There are few barriers to entry in the food distribution industry, which is opportune since consumers seek more locally sourced products. Existing competitors can relatively easily expand their product line or increase their geographic footprint. This is why the industry is so fragmented. Thus, there is a high threat of new entrants.

5.2. Bargaining Power of Suppliers (Low)

We consider the bargaining power of suppliers to be low. Food distributors typically purchase from thousands of suppliers, both domestic and international, and do not typically rely on any single supplier. These suppliers consist generally of large corporations selling brand name and private label goods, as well as independent, regional brand and private label processors and packers. Food distributors are also moving more into purchasing from small- to mid-sized producers in order to meet the growing demand for locally sourced products. Supplier agreements are typically negotiated on a centralized basis to reduce overhead costs.

5.3. Bargaining Power of Customers (High)

Given the highly fragmented market and the growth of many smaller food distributors, switching costs for buyers or customers are very low. Customers can make supplier and channel changes very quickly with minimal effort and cost. To combat the high bargaining power of buyers, large

food distributors look to acquire other smaller food distributors in order to control a greater portion of market share. Degree of Rivalry/Competition (High)

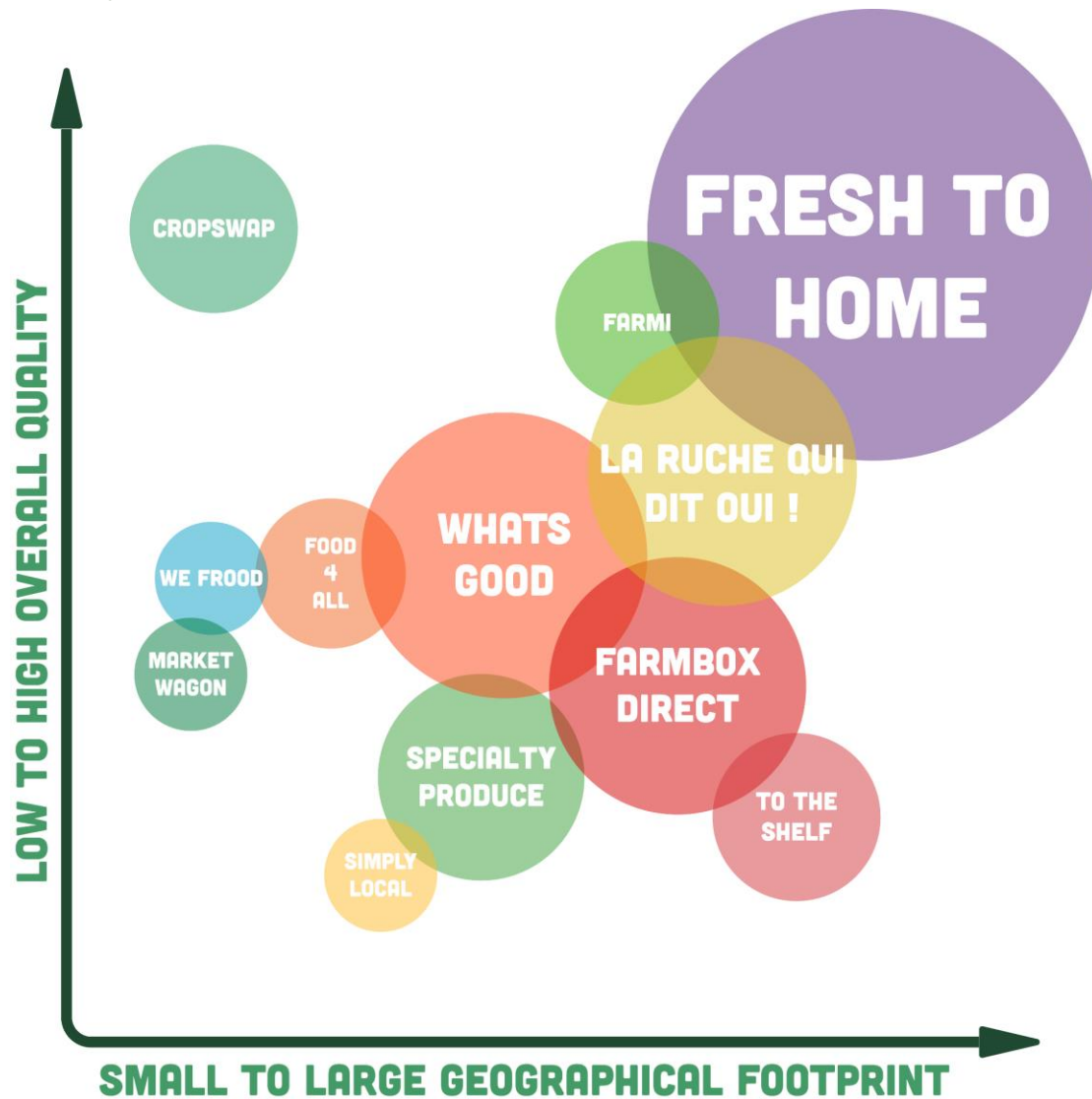
5.4. Degree of Rivalry/Competition (High)

The food distribution sub-industry is fragmented and highly competitive, with local, regional, and multi-regional distributors either carrying a large array of product categories or a limited number of niche product categories. There are several different types of food distributors in the marketplace, including broadline distributors (carrying a broad line of products and services), system distributors (carrying products for large chains), and specialized distributors (focusing on a specific product category like meat or produce). The rise of more specialized distributors with a local presence has magnified the competitiveness of this industry because these distributors have a competitive advantage from their close proximity to customers, which allows for a closer customer relationship and an enhanced speed-to-market operating model.

5.5. Threat of Substitutes (Moderate)

We consider the threat of substitutes to be moderate due to the growing number of nontraditional business models, which in turn is increasing the competition for traditional food distributors. Customers can also choose to purchase products directly from wholesale or retail outlets, including club, cash and carry, and grocery stores; from online retailers; or by negotiating prices directly with the suppliers of food distributors, which would effectively wipe out the food distributor as the intermediary.

6. Competitive Position of Major Companies/Strategic Groups



As can be seen in the diagram above, we have positioned the market competitors by analyzing them against two measurements, geographic footprint and overall product quality. The first measurement, geographic footprint, was measured by observing how many locations the company's platform is being used in around the world.

We chose to use geographic footprint as one of our measurements because we wanted to test the success of national vs international platforms. Metcalfe's law, also known as the network effect, is a huge factor in building out a platform like this, so it only makes sense to study apps with multinational influence. Also, agriculture is a global market and is currently in a new revolution as it adopts more and more technology.

Initially, we were going to rate a company's product quality by simply observing the design and flow of their app's UI/UX. We later settled on using multiple factors because we did not want to input too much of our own bias. Instead, we decided to add in as much influence from the millions of customers that have actually used these apps and taken the time to rate them and comment about their experiences. Because of our change in strategy, we decided to measure overall product quality by analyzing four factors. These four factors include: number of downloads on the Google play store, 1-5 star rating on the Apple app store, whether they have an app or not, and usability/design of their platform. Once the four factors were measured, we added up the total score for each company, compared each company's total, and then plotted each company on the diagram from lowest to highest.

7. Competitor Analysis

Every one of the market competitors is a privately held company and the overwhelming majority are growing organically with little to no marketing budget. The main competitors we identified are Fresh To Home, La Ruche, Farmi, CropSwap, and Food 4 All. Each of these companies has a slightly different approach to sourcing/distributing goods and services in this market, and each of their methods come with pros and cons.

7.1 Fresh To Home

The largest and fastest growing competitor in this market is not in the United States. Fresh To Home is an app founded in 2015 and headquartered in Bengaluru, India. Their platform is being used in markets such as:

India: Bangalore, Delhi / NCR / Jaipur, Mumbai, Pune, Chennai, Hyderabad, Cochin, Trivandrum, Thrissur, Calicut (Kozhikode), Coimbatore

UAE: Dubai, Abu Dhabi, Sharjah, Ajman, Al Ain, Fujairah, Ras Al Khaimah, Umm Al Quwain

Fresh To Home has the largest market cap and has received the most Venture Capital funding out of all the competitors as they aim to "Uber-ize farmers and fishermen" for commodity exchange. Fresh To Home's Series C was led by Investment Corporation of Dubai, Investcorp, Ascent Capital, the U.S. government's development finance institution (DFC), and the Allana Group. Fresh To Home's US\$121 million round is the largest to date for a consumer-focused Indian startup in a Series C round. Iron Pillar, which led Fresh To Home's Series B round, invested US\$19 million in the new financing round and has raised a total of US\$154 million to date.

7.2 La Ruche qui dit oui!

La Ruche qui dit oui! is an app that is entirely in French and roughly translates to The Hive That Says Yes. La Ruche has the second largest amount of Venture Capital funding out of all the competitors as they recently raised US\$9 million in their series B round. The funding came from Fred Wilson at Union Square Ventures, Frederic Court at Felix Capital, XAnge, and Quadia. In 2015 they launched in the U.K., Germany, Spain, and Italy. CEO Marc-David Choukroun was quoted in a TechCrunch interview saying, "This round means that we need to solidify our existing markets" and "We need to go faster when it comes to our innovation power."

7.3 Farmi

Farmi's platform and business model is very different to ours, but we are still very interested in them because they give us insight into the Vietnamese and South Pacific markets. They are growing quickly and have a well-designed platform.

7.4 CropSwap

CropSwap is a small startup out of Las Angeles, CA, and they have a business model similar to our own. CropSwap has boasted about how they are able to keep their fees as low as 8% because they do not waste their money on marketing and other growth strategies, which is pretty clear since they have yet to break out of the LA bubble. They have recently updated their app's UI/UX, and it is significantly better than their original design. They are currently shifting their business model to a CSA box style of delivery. We believe this is a bad idea, but we will be keeping a close eye on them to see if this helps or hurts them.

7.5 Food 4 All

Food 4 All is a very interesting company although they do not have a mobile app, which hurt them in our rankings. They have received a US\$100,000 grant from the USDA and are looking into how they can help get local food into schools and hospitals. They are mostly concentrated in the Portland, OR area but have started to see the platform pop up in a few more areas around the US.

8. Industry Key Success Factors

The research we have done up to this point to develop a more detailed understanding of the fruit and vegetable markets has led us to believe that the following characteristics can be identified as Key Success Factors (KSFs) in this industry:

8.1. High Adaptability to Consumers' Dynamic shifts in Preferences

In this industry, consumers' preferences regarding types of products in demand, their shopping experience, etc., dynamically undergo changes that shapes the industry's future. These changes are essentially driven by two main types of disruptive events: abrupt and gradual. The abrupt disruptive events are usually more difficult or sometimes nearly impossible to predict when it will occur and how it will impact the industry. The recent Covid-19 pandemic is an example of an abrupt disruptive event. On the other hand, a gradual disruptive event can be easier to predict. However, they tend to have a more active and more direct impact as the industry evolves. The rise of technology and process automation is an example of gradual disruptive events.

Businesses in this industry need to be sufficiently flexible to be able to adapt to these types of disruptive events in order to survive and expand.

8.2. Wide Range of Products

Merchandise mix helps determine physical store locations. For example, grocery stores with a broad range of products may seek out strip malls or areas with other large retailers to help drive traffic. Because customers are willing to travel to buy unique merchandise, stores specializing in a few categories, such as meat or produce markets, may be farther from major shopping areas.

8.3. Strategic Location Selection

When evaluating store locations, companies typically consider population density, traffic patterns, tenant mix, visibility, and accessibility. Because specialty food products tend to appeal to affluent consumers, companies may also consider education and income levels for the surrounding area.

8.4. Diverse Range of Utilized Marketing Avenues

Marketing and promotional vehicles include in-store signage, newspaper and print advertising, direct mail, and coupons. Grassroots marketing and word-of-mouth are important to generate awareness as well as most companies have relatively small marketing budgets. Product tastings, cooking classes, and sampling help create excitement and draw traffic. Stores may sponsor local events or charities to develop community support

8.5. Cost Control

Because supermarkets and stores in this industry are low-margin businesses, controlling costs is critical. The difference between strong and weak players may be decided by a mere 1% difference in net margins.

9. Conclusions About Industry Prospects and Overall Attractiveness

This section will discuss issues specific to the agriculture industry which make it attractive or unattractive for new companies to enter the market.

9.1. Attractive Industry Factors

We learned that the market for local food has a high projected growth rate and has already experienced a significant amount of growth in the last decade. Agriculture is a market of commodities, which we believe makes this market very attractive. Commodities like food are essential to life and will continue to be as such, so all people must buy food for their entire life. We also see emerging markets and their unprecedented growth potential as an opportunity. Countries like India, Vietnam, and many others in Africa and Latin America are beginning to enter a new era of economic growth due to their adoption of manufacturing, technology, and automation.

9.2. Unattractive Industry Factors

We have learned that agriculture is a low margin business that is fairly inelastic because of its commodity status. We also have observed that the current supply chain is fairly vulnerable and fragile due to how susceptible it is to natural disasters, droughts, and other outside influences. The agriculture industry also has a high turnover of inventory because food is very perishable, causing a massive amount of food waste every year. Other unattractive aspects of the market include high transportation costs, high environmental impact, and the complexity of supply chain logistics.

9.3. Special Industry Issues / Problems

We see some of the problems that face the current market as being digitization, globalization, local movement, supply chain transparency, and sustainability.

9.4. Profit Outlooks

Something that is more favorable about this market is that the growth rates are increasing for local food and for e-commerce as a method of purchasing food. Many people believe these rates have accelerated because of Covid-19, growing from 3% to 10% for the adoption of e-commerce grocery. We also see how decreasing costs from tech adoption has created a major profit opportunity.

10. Conclusions About Your Team's New Venture Opportunity

This section summarizes what was learned when creating this ICA, and how it relates to this venture.

10.1. What We Learned

We learned that while the food industry is highly competitive with low margins as food is classified as a commodity, there are certainly profit opportunities in emerging technologies. The combination of digitization of food and shifting attitudes towards local food, sustainably produced food, and supply chain transparency trends were all accelerated due to the impacts of Covid-19. There is no single dominant competitor in the specialty food/food distribution space, but the highly fragmented market and Covid-19 tailwinds present an opportunity for Eden to thrive in this niche of the food industry.

Eden must develop a solution that simultaneously provides demanding consumers their choice of fresh and local high-quality food in a convenient manner with minimum price premium in the form of an intuitive seamless web and mobile application. Eden's key opportunities lie in having a well-functioning product targeted to a global market with an initial focus on developing markets, such as in India, Southeast Asia, Central and South America, and Africa in addition to the home base in the United States.

10.2. FVRI Framework

Fit

One group member has a background in agriculture and data analysis. While the other two group members do not have a background in agriculture or food, there is a passionate interest in the purpose of this venture. The group members have a very well-balanced and highly diverse and multicultural mix of backgrounds and skills, to include design, data analysis, language, culture, and scientific method. This eclectic mix has worked quite well thus far, and there is no reason to believe that it will not continue to do so.

Value

Eden is a virtual marketplace that removes the barriers preventing regular people from conveniently accessing fresh and local food. It is a facilitation mechanism for supporting the community and fostering relationships with food and those who produce it. Eden connects people with their environment and the food that comes from it. It is a source of knowledge and online community where people can gather and learn.

Rarity

Based on the results of our research, we have identified other companies that are similar in nature to Eden but are sufficiently different in that there are discernible points of differentiation between the companies. All the companies offer at least one similar feature that Eden offers but none has the entire suite of features that Eden offers, which leaves Eden as the current sole source of all the included features.

Imitability

The design and initial implementation of an application similar to Eden is easy to imitate. However, the successful execution of the idea is highly challenging, and the culture and following that any successful application garners is difficult to imitate. Food is a very personal part of people's identity, and if the Eden brand resonates with people's identity, the brand loyalty would be hard to replicate.

10.3. Next Steps

Based on the analysis results from this ICA, the Eden team plans to continue forward with the venture. We believe that the unique circumstances in which we find ourselves with the confluence of the Covid-19 pandemic, digitization of food, and shift in consumer preferences to being more environmentally and socially conscientious are a nexus in which the Eden concept can take off. The next steps in the venture will be to build and test a minimum viable product of the application, concurrently optimize revenue models, and continue with customer discovery.

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